06 Routing and dial plans

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Pro tips

• Normalization is first match. A later rule does not repair a number an earlier rule already rewrote.

• A voice routing policy is an ordered list of PSTN usages. The first usage that contains a matching route wins.

• Direct Routing needs the user in TeamsOnly. Islands mode does not send that user's PSTN calls through Teams.

Interview traps

• Debugging the gateway when the dialed string never became E.164.

• Creating a route and forgetting to put its PSTN usage on the user's policy, in the right order.

Cheat sheet

Dialed string

→ tenant dial plan, first matching rule

→ E.164

→ voice routing policy usages, in order

→ first voice route regex that matches

→ online PSTN gateway list

Islands mode does not place Direct Routing calls.

Facts in the long lessons were checked 14 October 2026. This sheet is a memory aid.

Sources and go deeper

- Create and manage dial plans — Microsoft Learn — last checked 2026-10.
- Manage voice routing policies — Microsoft Learn — last checked 2026-10.
- RFC 3966 — RFC — last checked 2026-10.
- E.164 — Wikipedia — last checked 2026-10. Wikipedia fallback for background. Confirm the vendor page before you change a tenant.

- Microsoft Teams blog index — Community — last checked 2026-10. Community index for the Microsoft Teams blog. This is the index, not a claim that a post discusses this room.
- Plan Direct Routing — Microsoft Learn — last checked 2026-10.
- Emergency locations, addresses, and routing — Microsoft Learn — last checked 2026-10.

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Repo: github.com/CypherMonkeyLabs/microsoft-voice-cc-lab-free-university-mesmerizing

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